

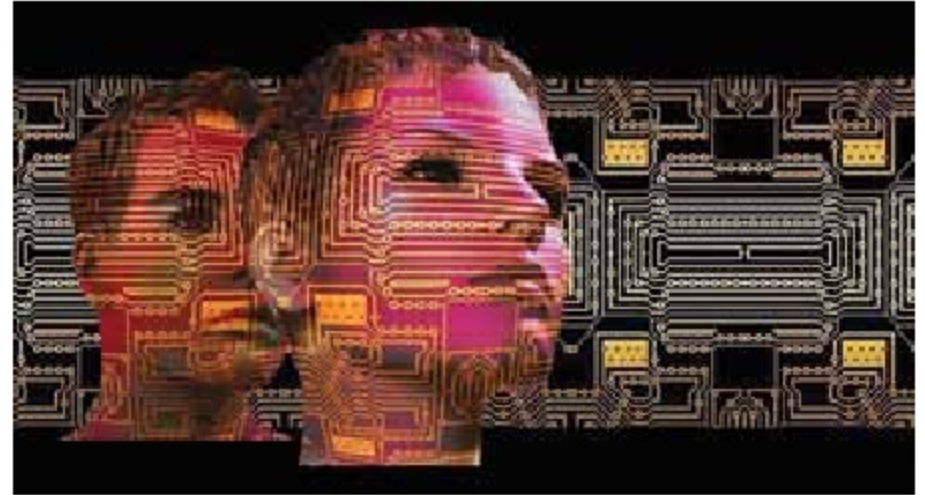
Microsoft launches Video Authenticator to detect deepfake media

Microsoft has introduced new software that aims to help people detect deepfake photos and videos. Called Video Authenticator, the application gives a confidence score to help users identify whether the media is artificially manipulated.

Microsoft said that the new technology can provide the confidence score or percentage change in real time on each frame as the media plays. The application can detect the blending boundary used by deepfakes. It can also spot nuances such as fading or grayscale, which may be missed by the human eye.

The tool was built using a public dataset from agencies such as Face Forensic++. Microsoft tested the tool on the DeepFake Detection Challenge Dataset. These two were leading models for training and testing the Video Authenticator tool.

Microsoft's new tool comes at a time when deepfake videos are being widely misused for spreading fake news and hoaxes. Already, these AI-based manipulated videos targeting people like Mark Zuckerberg and Bill Gates are getting circulated.



Microsoft launches Video Authenticator to detect deepfake photos and videos
(Credit: Pixabay)

Apart from Microsoft, the likes of Facebook are also working on improved deepfake detection methods. Earlier this year, the company hosted a Deepfake Detection Challenge as well.

The most in-demand programming languages in India

Technology has become an integral part of our personal and working lives. As technology continues to develop and more innovations are brought to the table, the demand for the appropriate technical skills to make these a reality is set to surge. Keeping this in mind, Prolifics Testing, an IT consultancy, has discovered the technology-related jobs that Indians are most interested in and the programming languages they most want to learn.

As per the report, Indians are most interested in data scientist jobs, with an average of 31,000 online searches per month. Data analyst roles generate the second greatest amount of interest, with 28,000 online queries each month. Software engineer (15,000), Web developer (14,000), and software developer (12,000) jobs accumulate more than 11,000 online

searches a month each.

On the other end, Python developer jobs gain just 8,100 online searches per month, making it the least popular.

The report further adds that Indians are most focused on learning Python, with an astonishing 291,000 online searches for it each month—the equivalent of 9,700 online searches a day. Java (134,300 online searches) is the next most popular programming language that individuals are trying to become proficient at.

JavaScript (108,200) and PHP (74,900) are each receiving over 70,000 online searches each from those keen to gain further knowledge on them. On the other end, R (10,650), C# (32,600), and CSS (33,400) are among the programming languages that Indians have less interest in learning.

IIT-Madras, Keysight collaborate to accelerate development of desi 5G standard

Keysight, a telecom testing solutions provider, has inked a partnership with the Indian Institute of Technology, Madras (IIT-M), to assist the Telecom Standards Development Society, India (TSDSI) in developing India-specific 5G standard. Under the partnership, IIT-M will provide the assistance of more than fifty engineers and researchers based out of its campus while Keysight Technologies will provide the required equipment for the project.

Keysight is currently building on the functionality required for testing of new radio interface standards developed at IIT Madras, the company said in a joint statement.

The 5G RIT developed by TSDSI improves upon the RIT

developed by the 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) to conform with ITU's Low Mobility Large Cell (LMLC) rural use case. The TSDSI 5G RIT seeks to provide improved 5G coverage in rural areas with low-speed mobility and large cells of up to 6km radius.

The homegrown technology further aims to bridge the digital divide by enabling affordable 5G broadband, leveraging the BharatNet optical fibre network deployed in rural areas.

The telecom department (DoT) has initiated the funding of a large-scale '5G Testbed' project with an aim to take an early lead in the 5G technology and to build a testbed that resembles real-world 5G deployment.